



ANIMAL FIGHTS WERE POPULAR. HERE, A BEAR MAULS A BEAST-FIGHTER, WHILE TWO MEN USE WHIPS TO BEAT IT AWAY.

had the worst seats, right at the top of the building. Seated below them were soldiers and ordinary citizens, then civil servants and officers, and finally, closest to the ringside, senators and their guests.

With so many spectators crammed inside, crowd control in the Colosseum was essential. The building was designed so that it could be emptied quickly

and safely at the end of a show, with crowds spewing from its *vomitoria* (openings) onto the city streets. There were 80 of these entrance-and-exit places, of which the public could use 76. Two were for the emperor and his courtiers, and two were for gladiatorial processions.

On hot days, a canopy was stretched across the arena to give shade for the spectators, so they could watch the suffering in the arena in comfort! This vast, billowing sun blind,

THE FLOOR OF THE COLOSSEUM IS LONG GONE, SO TODAY'S VISITORS CAN SEE THE UNDERGROUND PASSAGES AND CHAMBERS.

